



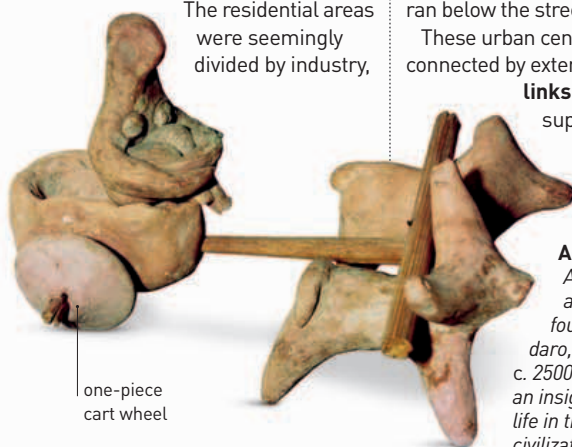
The ruined citadel of Mohenjo-daro was made up of various buildings. It was built on a platform to guard against flooding of the Indus River.

**IN THE SECOND HALF OF THE 3RD MILLENNIUM BCE**, civilizations continued to develop in western Asia, Egypt, and southern Asia, and complex societies were emerging in China, Europe, and South America.

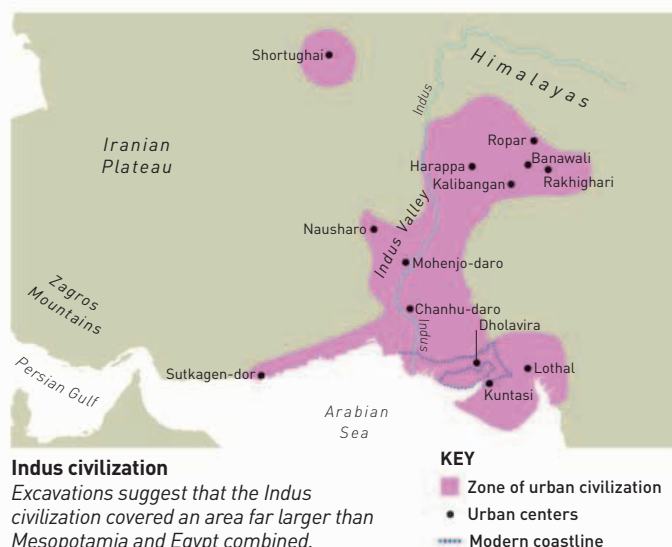
In southern Asia, the **Indus civilization** (see 2700–2500BCE) emerged in its mature form around 2500BCE, stretching 1,060 miles (1,700 km) from east to west and 800 miles (1,300 km) from north to south. The region's prosperity was based on farming, mining, crafts, and trade. More than 100 sites have been excavated, including the cities of Mohenjo-daro, Harappa, and Dholovira.

**Mohenjo-daro and Harappa** were **well-planned** cities laid out on a grid system. Each city was protected by brick walls and dominated by a **citadel** overlooking a “lower town” of public buildings and residential **town houses** of one or two stories.

The residential areas were seemingly divided by industry,



one-piece cart wheel



#### Indus civilization

Excavations suggest that the Indus civilization covered an area far larger than Mesopotamia and Egypt combined.

such as pottery, bead-making, and metalworking.

Indus cities and towns had the most **advanced plumbing** system in the ancient world, with enclosed wells and covered drains. Latrines emptied waste into drains, which ran below the streets.

These urban centers were also connected by extensive **trade links**. Merchants supplied craft products from the valleys to

#### Agrarian lives

A clay model of a bullock cart found at Mohenjo-daro, dating back to c. 2500–1900 BCE, gives an insight into farming life in the Indus civilization.

the surrounding regions in return for metal ores, precious stones, and timber. Long-distance trade routes reached as far as Mesopotamia and Afghanistan.

By around 2500 BCE, an **Indus script** of hundreds of signs appeared on seals and pottery. Attempts to decipher the script have failed; hence, many aspects of this culture remain a mystery.

In western Asia, **Mesopotamia** (see 2700–2500BCE) remained a patchwork of small but **powerful city-states**, each controlling the surrounding farmlands where barley, legumes, and date palms were grown. To the west, city-states were developing in Syria and the Levant. A **trade network** linking Mesopotamian towns suggests cooperation between states, but there was **frequent warfare** as well.



Silbury Hill in Wiltshire, England, is one of the tallest man-made chalk mounds in Europe. These mounds probably had a social or cultural function.

#### A NEW POWER AROSE IN

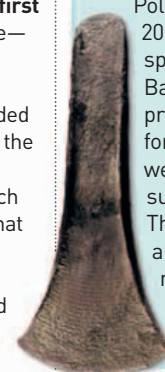
**MESOPOTAMIA** c. 2334BCE, **King Sargon** (c. 2334–2215BCE) from the northern region of **Akkad** defeated Lugalzagesi of Umma to become the ruler of Sumer. Through subsequent campaigns to the Levant, Syria, and Anatolia, Sargon carved out the **world's first empire**—the Akkadian Empire—stretching from the eastern Mediterranean to the Gulf.

Sargon's exploits were recorded in several documents, such as the *Sumerian King List*. His name means “**legitimate king**,” which led some scholars to believe that he took power through force. Sargon spoke Akkadian, a Semitic language that replaced Sumerian as the official language of the empire.

#### BRONZE AGE EUROPE

Bronze-working had begun in West Asia c. 3200BCE (see 10,000–3000BCE). It was developed by the Únětice culture of Bohemia and

Poland c. 2500BCE, and 200 years later had spread to Italy and the Balkans. Bronze provided a hard metal for forging armor, weapons, and tools such as this hand ax. The bronze industry also increased trade, making Europe more interconnected than ever before.



“ **UNDER HIM ALL COUNTRIES LAY [CONTENTED] IN THEIR MEADOWS, AND THE LAND REJOICED.** ”

**Lugalzagesi, king of Sumer**, defeated by Sargon c. 2316 BCE

Akkadian rule was enforced through regional governors who collected tributes and taxes. The **empire's weakness** lay in its lack of defensible **borders**, and it came under regular **attacks** from neighboring **hill tribes**. Sargon's

grandson, Naram-Sin, extended the empire, but it lasted for only four generations before falling to attacks. Sargon's rule established a practice of statewide bureaucratic controls and standardization in many aspects of economic life.

In **Egypt**, this period saw a **weakening** of the power of the **Old Kingdom** rulers (see 2700–2500BCE), in favor of regional governors called **nomarchs**, who administered different parts of the Nile valley and delta. To the south of the first cataract on the Nile, the kingdom of Nubia also grew **more powerful**. Nubia was centered around the city of Kerma at the third cataract. By the end of the **Sixth dynasty** (c. 2184BCE),

c. 2500 BCE Longshan culture in China produces pottery, bronze, and silk

c. 2500 BCE Ur a major center of manufacturing

c. 2500 BCE Ebla, Mari, and other cities in Syria and the Levant emerge

c. 2500 BCE Bronze Age begins in Central Europe

c. 2500 BCE Mature phase of Indus civilization emerges

c. 2500 BCE Indus script emerges

c. 2500 BCE Ceremonial centers, Aspero and Kotesh, continue to be built in coastal Peru and the Andes

c. 2500 BCE Old Kingdom Period continues in Egypt

c. 2500 BCE Bell Beaker culture spreads in Western and Central Europe

c. 2500 BCE Evidence of long-distance trade routes in South America

c. 2400 BCE Eannatum of Lagash rules areas of Sumer

c. 2400 BCE All stones erected at Stonehenge ceremonial complex in southwest Britain

c. 2350 BCE Lugalzagesi of Umma unites all Sumer

c. 2345–2181 BCE Sixth dynasty of Egypt founded

c. 2334–2316 BCE Sargon of Akkad conquers Sumer to create world's first empire